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Choosing Wisely with Your New Identity

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Choosing Wisely with Your New Identity

“Do not be conformed to this present world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, so that you may test and approve what is the will of God—what is good and well-pleasing and perfect.” — Romans 12:2

Our decisions are consistent with our self-image. What we believe about ourselves shapes the choices we make each day. Popular reminders like “What Would Jesus Do?” bracelets are helpful, yet they can sometimes feel distant because Jesus was perfect and we are not. It is easy to think, “Jesus would choose that, but that is not who I am.”

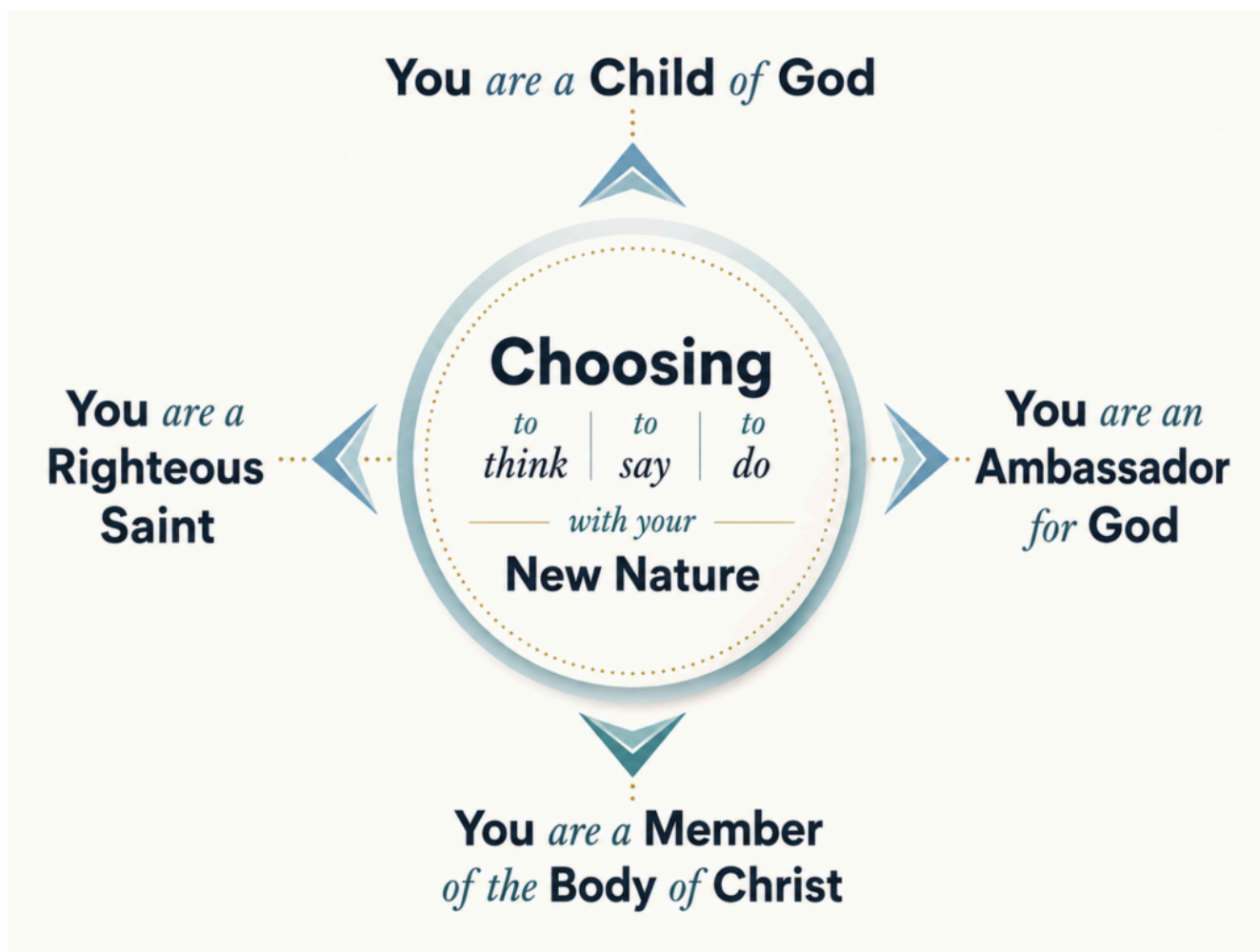
However, because of your new identity in Christ, you can now ask different questions: What would a child of God choose? What would a saint with a new nature choose? What would a member of the body of Christ choose? What would a citizen of God’s kingdom choose?

How you see yourself determines the choices you make. When you were spiritually born again, God radically changed you.

“So then, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; what is old has passed away—look, what is new has come!” (2 Corinthians 5:17).

At the time of your spiritual birth, you were transformed into a totally new person with a new nature. On the outside you may still look the same, but on the inside God gave you a new identity in Christ. It is like being adopted. You may not feel any different after the adoption papers are signed, but in reality you have become part of a new family, with new legal rights and a different destiny.

That is what happened to you spiritually. As a result, you must learn who you are now in Christ so you may make choices consistent with this spiritual transformation. It is foolish to live in the past by continuing to make decisions based on your old identity.



Based on who you now are in Christ, what do you choose to think, to say, and to do?

- What would a child of God choose?
- What would a righteous saint choose?
- What would a member of the body of Christ choose?
- What would an ambassador for God choose?

“You, however, did not come to know Christ that way. Surely you heard of him and were taught in him in accordance with the truth that is in Jesus. You were taught, with regard to your former way of life, to put off your old self, which is being corrupted by its deceitful desires; to be made new in the attitude of your minds; and to put on the new self, created to be like God in true righteousness and holiness” (Ephesians 4:20-24).

“Put to death, therefore, whatever belongs to your earthly nature... You used to walk in these ways, in the life you once lived... Do not lie to each other, since you have taken off your old self with its practices and have put on the new self, which is being renewed in knowledge in the image of its Creator” (Colossians 3:5-10).

“...clothe yourselves with the Lord Jesus Christ, and do not think about how to gratify the desires of the sinful nature” (Romans 13:14).

God Has Given You New Priorities

“Therefore, if you have been raised with Christ, keep seeking the things above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God. Set your mind on the things above, not on the things that are on earth. For you have died and your life is hidden with Christ in God” (Colossians 3:1-4).

God has given us spiritual priorities for decision-making that point us in the right direction for life. These four priorities are like a spiritual compass that will lead us to eternal significance and fulfillment.

- Commit yourself to **pursuing intimacy with God**.
“Jesus said to him, ‘You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, and with all your soul, and with all your mind.’ This is the first and greatest commandment” (Matthew 22:37-38).
- Commit yourself to **becoming Christlike in your character**.
“For those whom he foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that his Son would be the firstborn among many brothers and sisters” (Romans 8:29).
- Commit yourself to **building up one another in Christ**.
“To equip the saints for the work of ministry, that is, to build up the body of Christ” (Ephesians 4:12).
- Commit yourself to **being God’s ambassador** to those who don’t know Him.
“Therefore we are ambassadors for Christ, as though God were making his plea through us. We plead with you on Christ’s behalf, ‘Be reconciled to God!’” (2 Corinthians 5:20).

How do your life goals reflect these spiritual priorities?

Making Wise Choices Requires

- **The right perspective** — Renew your mind with God's truth so your reasoning is based on reality and on God's priorities. God has given us the freedom to choose but He has not given us freedom from the consequences.
- **Sensitivity to the Holy Spirit** — Avoid the noise of human reasoning and fickle emotion. Listen to the still inner voice of the Holy Spirit.
- **Harmony with God's will** — Disobedience and independence from God does not bring fulfillment—it brings judgment.
- **A correct self-image** — Make decisions consistent with who you are now in Christ.
- **Commitment to God's Priorities** — Intimacy with God, character development, body life, and outreach.

What decisions are you facing in your life right now? Take a few minutes in prayer to consider these principles. How do they relate to your situation? Ask the Holy Spirit to guide you.

Good decisions are based on sound reasoning. However, meticulous reasoning with the wrong input still results in wrong conclusions—conclusions which we assume to be factual and which will direct our actions.

Living It Out

Thinking with a renewed mind is absolutely essential for wise decision-making. The Holy Spirit communicates with us through our spirit. But we can only hear His inner voice when we quiet our mind and emotions. We must find an environment free from noisy distractions, eliminate mental preoccupation, and yield our will to God.

Reflection

What decisions are you facing right now? How would viewing them through the lens of your new identity—as a child of God, a saint, a member of the body, and a citizen of the kingdom—change your perspective and choices?

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for my new identity in Christ. Renew my mind with Your truth. Help me to make every decision in light of who I now am in You. Guide me by Your Spirit and align my choices with Your priorities. Amen.”

Memory Verse

“Do not be conformed to this present world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, so that you may test and approve what is the will of God—what is good and well-pleasing and perfect” (Romans 12:2).

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

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Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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